

Sheikh Arsalan-ul-Haque

arsalan@udel.edu | Website | LinkedIn

Education

University of Delaware

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

Newark, DE

Expected May 2028

Advisor: Adrienne Lucas. **Committee:** Sabrin Beg and Maria Rosales-Rueda. **External member:** Kate Vyborny.

University of Delaware

M.S. in Economics and Applied Econometrics

Newark, DE

June 2025

Lahore University of Management Sciences

B.Sc. (Honors) in Economics and Mathematics

Lahore, Pakistan

June 2021

GPA: 3.75/4.00; graduated with distinction.

Research Interests

Development Economics; Gender and Family Economics; Health Economics; Labor Economics.

Working Papers

- **Unilateral Divorce and the Marriage Market: Evidence from India's Triple Talaq Ban**

[Job Market Paper] (with Rounak Bose)

Abstract. Divorce reform can affect not only whether marriages dissolve, but also which existing marriages persist, who enters marriage, and the outcomes of marriages formed under the new law. We study India's ban and September 2018 criminalization of triple talaq, an instantaneous form of unilateral divorce historically available to Muslim husbands. Using nationally representative surveys and retrospective marriage histories, we compare changes among Muslim women with those among non-Muslim women in a difference-in-differences framework. Among marriages formed before the reform, we estimate a decline in formal divorce, and the remaining married population shifts toward women who married younger, have husbands at least five years older, and report less say over their husbands' earnings. These patterns are consistent with some marriages remaining intact that would otherwise have dissolved. First-marriage entry slows among women without primary completion, while the average estimate is imprecise. Our framework suggests that this decline could reflect greater reluctance among prospective husbands or fewer potential matches. Among marriages formed after the reform, divorce and emotional intimate partner violence decline without consistent socioeconomic upgrading. This pattern is consistent with a favorable behavioral response within marriage.

- **Intended and Unintended Consequences of a De Facto Inheritance Reform** *(with Sabrin Beg, Erica Field, Kate Vyborny, Suzanna Khalifa, and Jeremy Lebow)*

Studies the effects of Punjab's land-record digitization on women's inheritance rights, property access, and household outcomes.

- **Post-Natal Son Preference and Inheritance Reforms**

Examines how the reform affects child-health investments and measures of son preference.

Work in Progress

- **Marriage Bars, Women's Employment, and Intergenerational Outcomes** *(with Valerie Michelman and Barbara Biasi)*

Studies how U.S. restrictions on the employment of married women shaped labor-force participation and longer-run outcomes for their children.

Publication

Beg, Sabrin, and Sheikh Arsalan-ul-Haque. 2024. "Policy Recommendations for Advancing the Education Sector in Pakistan." In *Striving to Meet the Sustainable Development Goals: Next Steps for Policymakers and Practitioners*. Asian Development Bank Institute. doi:10.56506/IEJD6853.

Research Experience

University of Delaware <i>Graduate Research Assistant</i>	Newark, DE <i>Sep 2023–Present</i>
• Coauthor an evaluation of Punjab’s land-record digitization and its effects on women’s inheritance and property rights; construct and analyze primary and secondary data using staggered difference-in-differences. • Clean and analyze baseline and endline data for Reach Up Indonesia, a village-randomized early-childhood parenting program; estimate intention-to-treat and treatment-on-the-treated effects.	
The World Bank <i>Short-Term Consultant</i>	Remote <i>Jul 2024–Aug 2026</i>
• Conducted data cleaning, monitoring analysis, and high-frequency checks for the land-record digitization and inheritance-rights project. • Contributed to proposal development, background research, and survey planning with investigators and field teams in Pakistan.	
Center for Economic Research in Pakistan (CERP) <i>Research Associate</i>	Lahore, Pakistan <i>Sep 2022–Aug 2023</i>
• Programmed SurveyCTO instruments and coordinated survey design, field preparation, and data management for the Punjab land-digitization evaluation. • Coordinated with research partners, implementation teams, and government stakeholders.	
Lahore University of Management Sciences <i>Pre-Doctoral Research Associate</i>	Lahore, Pakistan <i>Aug 2021–Mar 2023</i>
• Supported field experiments on misinformation and digital literacy. • Contributed to intervention design, survey development, and pre-analysis planning; analyzed project data and produced spatial maps in ArcGIS.	

Teaching Experience

University of Delaware <i>Instructor of Record, Introduction to Macroeconomics (ECON 103)</i>	Newark, DE <i>Winter 2026</i>
Lahore University of Management Sciences <i>Adjunct Faculty, Development Economics (ECON 240)</i>	Lahore, Pakistan <i>Summer 2025</i>
Teaching Assistant, University of Delaware (Fall 2026): ECON 422: Econometric Methods for Causal Analysis; ECON 824: Topics in Applied Econometrics; and ECON 101 Honors Section: Introduction to Microeconomics.	
Teaching Assistant, Lahore University of Management Sciences: Econometrics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Calculus II, and Introduction to Game Theory.	

Technical Skills

Stata, R, Python, ArcGIS, SurveyCTO, and L^AT_EX.

Leadership and Service

Kaavish <i>Co-founder</i>	Lahore, Pakistan <i>Jul 2016–Present</i>
Founded and scaled a community-relief organization that has delivered more than 10,000 meals in underserved urban communities; led fundraising and vendor outreach.	

References

Adrienne Lucas Professor of Economics and Department Chair University of Delaware alucas@udel.edu	Sabrin Beg Associate Professor of Economics University of Delaware sbeg@udel.edu
Maria Fernanda Rosales-Rueda Assistant Professor of Economics University of Delaware mrosales@udel.edu	Kate Vyborny Economist, South Asia Gender Innovation Lab World Bank kvyborny@worldbank.org